

Drill Pack

Blind ID Drills · Both Directions · Error Log

Week 9 · Inquiry Continued (Limbs–Children) & Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling — 聞診 · Lecture 9 (Final Lecture)

Target: Drill until you can answer each item in under 3 seconds, both directions (Parts A–G forward, Part H reverse), with zero hesitation.

Print Edition

How drilling differs from studying: Reading builds understanding. Drilling builds **speed**. You can understand every table in the Study Guide and still blank under time pressure — these drills fix that. Fifteen minutes daily beats two hours on Sunday, especially with the Final one week out.

PART A · Blind ID — Limbs, Sleep & Sweating

Heads Up — Cover the right column. Read the description, name the pattern out loud, then uncover.

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Tingling sensation in limbs	Blood deficiency
Numbness, often unilateral	Wind or Wind-Phlegm
Joint pain that wanders, sore and aching	Wind
Severe, fixed joint pain, worse with cold	Cold
Atrophy/Flaccidity, later stages	LV/KI-Yin deficiency, or SP/KI-Yang deficiency
Tremors — always indicates	Liver-Wind (excess or deficiency type)
Cold fingertips especially	Liver-Qi stagnation
Cold feet, in women specifically	Liver-Blood deficiency
Weak knees	Deficiency of the Kidneys, esp. Kidney-Yang
Not being able to fall or stay asleep	Blood deficiency not anchoring Shen/Hun
Very restless sleep, heat, agitation, excess dreaming	Pathogens agitating Shen/Hun out of Blood (Full)
Difficulty falling asleep	Blood deficiency (usually Heart, can be LV/SP)
Waking many times during the night	Yin deficiency with Empty Heat
Waking early, can't fall back asleep	Gall Bladder deficiency
Sweating only on head	Heat in the Stomach, or Damp-Heat
Oily sweat on forehead, pearl-like	Collapse of Yang — imminent death
Sweating on palms, soles, and chest	Yin deficiency (five-palm heat)
Daytime sweating	Yang deficiency
Night sweating	Yin deficiency

PART B · Blind ID — Ears/Eyes & Cold/Heat/Fever

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Tinnitus, sudden onset	Full — Liver-Fire, Liver-Yang rising, or Liver-Wind
Tinnitus, gradual onset	Empty — Kidney deficiency

Tinnitus noise worse with pressure	Full condition
Low-pitched tinnitus like rushing water	Kidney deficiency
Blurred vision with floaters	Liver-Blood, Liver-Yin, or Kidney-Yin deficiency
Dry eyes	Liver and/or Kidney-Yin deficiency
Simultaneous aversion to cold and fever	Key sign of exterior pathogenic factor invasion (Tai Yang / Wei level)
Subjective feeling of heat in exterior-origin disease	Pathogen has entered the Interior
Alternating feeling of cold and heat	Shao Yang stage (GB/TH), or GB Heat at Qi level
What determines fever intensity (not pathogen type)	The struggle between Zheng Qi and the EPF
Cold limbs and abdomen	Spleen-Yang / Stomach-Yang deficiency
Cold hands and feet, especially fingers	Liver Qi stagnation
Heat worse in the afternoon or evening	Empty-Heat / Yin deficiency
Constant low-grade temperature	Damp-Heat
Fever in the middle of the night	Yin deficiency

PART C · Blind ID — Emotional Symptoms

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Depression + insomnia, palpitations, tiredness, weak limbs, loose stools	Spleen and Heart-Blood deficiency
Depression + cold hands, palpitations	Heart-Yang deficiency
Depression + lack of sense of direction, sadness	Liver-Blood deficiency
Depression (full) + moodiness, irritability, red tongue	Stagnant Liver-Qi turning into Heat
Depression + lump in the throat	Liver-Qi stagnation with Qi-Phlegm (Plum-Pit Qi)
Depression + purple tongue (chest area)	Heart-Blood stasis
Anxiety worse in evening + lack of willpower, dizziness, tinnitus	Kidney-Yin deficiency
Anxiety (full) + hypochondrial distention	Liver-Qi stagnation
Anxiety + temple headache, tinnitus, deafness, dizziness	Liver-Yang rising
Anxiety + anger outbursts, red eyes, bitter taste, dark urine	Liver-Fire
Anxiety + stabbing chest pain radiating to inner left arm	Heart-Blood stasis (TCM description of a heart attack)
Anxiety + manic behavior, mental confusion, swollen tongue	Phlegm-Fire harassing the Mind
Worry, obsessive thinking + palpitations, loose stools	Heart and Spleen Qi deficiency
Worry which increases after the period in women	Liver-Blood deficiency
Sadness/grief + breathlessness, dislike speaking	Lung and Heart-Qi deficiency
Which organ alone "knows" what an emotion is	Heart (houses the Shen/consciousness)

PART D · Blind ID — Sexual, Women's & Children's

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Impotence + feeling cold, backache, clear urine	Kidney–Yang deficiency
Heaviness of the scrotum, urethral discharge, sticky yellow coat	Damp–Heat in the Liver channel
Premature ejaculation, younger men — more often	Heart–related (settling of the Heart, performance anxiety)
Tiredness and dizziness after ejaculation	Deficiency of the Kidneys
Excessive sexual desire (women or men)	Liver or Heart–Fire, or Empty–Heat from Kidney–Yin deficiency
Headache after orgasm	Rebellious Qi of the Chong Mai, or Heart–Fire
Periods always early	Blood–Heat, or Qi deficiency
Periods irregular, sometimes early sometimes late	Stagnation of Liver–Qi/Blood, or Spleen deficiency
Purple or blackish menstrual blood	Stasis of Blood or Cold
Pain before the period	Stagnation of Qi or Blood
Pain after the period	Blood deficiency
Yellow leukorrhea	Damp–Heat in the Lower Burner
Miscarriage before 3 months	Blood or Essence deficiency
Miscarriage after 3 months	Liver–Blood stasis, or sinking of Spleen–Qi
Vomiting of milk and colic in babies	Retention of food
Chronic earache in children	Damp–Heat in the Gall Bladder channel
Skin rash, insomnia, character change after immunizations	Latent Heat

PART E · Blind ID — Voice, Breathing & Reflexive Sounds

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Organ that governs production of the voice	Lung
Organ that governs volume of the voice	Kidney
Organ(s) that govern strength of the voice	Spleen & Stomach
Sudden loss of voice	Invasion of Wind-Heat
Hoarseness: chronic, gradual, worse in evening	Lung and Kidney Yin deficiency
Deep breathing	Excess qi in Heart and Lungs
Panting, deficiency type	Timid breath, low voice, worse with movement — Kidney or Lung deficiency
Wheezing	Lung qi fails to descend with phlegm obstruction
Dry cough	Lung-Yin deficiency
Shared mechanism of vomiting, belching, and hiccup	Rebellious Stomach Qi
Loud, forceful hiccup	Full — often Liver-Qi invading the Stomach
Borborygmi, loud sound	Full pattern (with diarrhea or dysentery)
Yawning, frequent/loud, emotion-induced	Liver Qi Stagnation
Sighing from repressed anger/frustration	Liver Qi stagnation

PART F · Blind ID — Five Element Sounds & Six Healing Sounds

Description (cover the right)	Answer
Shouting voice — element	Wood Hū 呼
Laughing voice — element	Fire Xiào 笑
Singing voice — element	Earth Chàng 唱
Weeping voice — element	Metal
Groaning voice — element	Water
Xū 嘘 Healing Sound — organ & effect	Liver — removes heat, brightens eyes
Hē 呵 Healing Sound — organ & effect	Heart — expels heat, reduces fire
Hū 呼 Healing Sound — organ & effect	Spleen — drives out heat, strengthens spleen
Chuī 吹 Healing Sound — organ & effect	Kidney — removes wind-cold, urges stagnant qi
Xī 嘻 Healing Sound — organ & effect	Triple Burner — clears heat/restlessness, emotions
Which hanzi/pinyin is shared between a Voice Sound and a Healing Sound?	Hū 呼 — Shout (Wood voice) AND Spleen Healing Sound

PART G · Blind ID — Smelling Framework, Five Odors & Secretions

Description (cover the right)	Answer
First aspect of Diagnosis by Smelling	Odor of the patient's body itself — pattern AND constitutional type
General rule: strong/foul/rotten smell	Heat or Excess
General rule: absent or fishy smell	Cold or Deficient
"Fragrant" odor (Xiāng 香) — description	Cloying, sickly sweet, lingers in nostrils — NOT actually pleasant
"Scorched" odor slide's labeled hanzi (and the likely error)	Xiào 笑 (reused from Laughing) — classical scorched is Jiāo 焦
Breath: fishy	Phlegm-Heat in Lung
Sweat: putrid-smelling	Disease of Lungs, Liver, or Kidneys
Sputum: without smell	Cold
Flatulence: rancid, like rotten eggs	Toxic Heat in Large Intestines
Urine: heavy urea smell, scanty yellow	Heart fire pouring into Bladder
Odorless urinary incontinence	Exhaustion of Kidney fire
Vaginal discharge: fishy smell	Damp-Cold
Eyes: red/swollen, turbid tears, foul fishy odor	Damp-heat in the Liver channel

PART H · Reverse Direction — Pattern → Finding

Heads Up — Now cover the LEFT column instead. Read the pattern, recall the finding that points to it.

Finding (cover the left)	Pattern (read this side)
Cold fingertips especially	Liver-Qi stagnation
Waking up many times at night	Yin deficiency with Empty Heat
Sudden tinnitus, worse with pressure	Full — Liver-Fire/Yang rising/Wind
Constant low-grade fever, doesn't fully clear with sweating	Damp-Heat
Stabbing chest pain radiating to inner left arm, purple tongue	Heart-Blood stasis (TCM "heart attack")
Cold feet, specifically in women	Liver-Blood deficiency
Miscarriage after 3 months	Liver-Blood stasis, or Spleen-Qi sinking
Chronic earache in a child	Damp-Heat in the Gall Bladder channel
Loud voice, excessive talking	Full or Heat
Hoarse, worse in the evening, chronic	Lung and Kidney Yin deficiency
Frequent loud yawning, emotion-triggered	Liver Qi Stagnation
Shouting	Wood
Foul, strong, rotten smell (general rule)	Heat or Excess
Clear, frequent, odorless urine	Kidney deficiency

Error Log

Heads Up — Every time you miss a drill item, log it here. Review this page before your next drill session — your errors are more valuable than your correct answers.

Item I Missed	Correct Answer / Why I Missed It